CONFIDENTIAL — INTERNAL STRATEGY DELIVERABLE

Partner-Fit Audit

DGTL Studios × DGTL Records — 20 Maud Street

Proposed studio venture, Unit B3 (lower level), 20 Maud Street, Toronto · assessed as prospective studio-operator and rights partner

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SECTION 01

Executive Summary

The venture has a genuine and unusual asset, and it is not the room. A working sound engineer already owns a full recording, mixing and mastering complement, which means the capital question is a build question rather than a signal-chain question — and in a sector where Ontario's studio employers are overwhelmingly one-to-four-person businesses, an operator who arrives with the gear already paid for starts several years ahead of the field. Alongside it sits a second asset nobody has monetised: every master he has recorded to date is unregistered and earning nothing, and correcting that costs under three hundred dollars in year one.

What is not established is almost everything else. The operator has not been assessed — no name, entity, credit list or client roster has been supplied to this review. The target unit, B3, appears in the landlord's own tenant record as occupied, and no below-grade vacancy at 20 Maud is publicly listed at any rate. And the argument doing the most work in the concept — that being next door to Archive Threads will bring business — is unsupported in its usual form: two research passes found no case anywhere of a recording studio attributing bookings to a neighbouring shop, and the brand-funded in-store studio is a category that has closed everywhere it was tried.

What is already working is the demand backdrop and DGTL's own half of the proposition. Ontario production reached $2.70 billion in 2025, national studio revenue rose 10.2 percent, and Canadian sync grew 11.0 percent. DGTL's verified record contains the two capabilities the venture most needs — a commerce-grade booking build (The 400 Market: Next.js, Payload, Stripe, bidirectional CRM, 90/91 Lighthouse) and a production pipeline that already buys audio post it currently sources elsewhere. Those are the seats where fit is strongest, and they do not depend on the adjacency argument being true.

This review records 23 findings across six categories, 6 of them Critical. Category D is included specifically because it is healthy. The distribution matters more than the count: most of the Critical findings are cheap to clear and clear in a conversation rather than a workstream — three of the six are resolved by a phone call to the landlord, a phone call to the neighbour, and one honest conversation with the friend. What is expensive is the sequence. Nothing in Section 07 should begin before Phase 0 closes.

FINDINGS AT A GLANCE

6	9	7	1	23
CRITICAL	HIGH	MEDIUM	LOW	TOTAL

Partner-fit severity lens: Critical means something DGTL would inherit reputationally or contractually on the day it attaches its name. It does not track effort — four of the six Critical findings are rated Low effort.

ID	FINDING	EFFORT	OWNER
A-01	**No assessment of the proposed operator has been possible**	Low	Partner
B-01	**Unit B3 is recorded as occupied; no lower-level vacancy is listed**	Low	DGTL
B-02	**Lease term is the dominant risk in the venture**	Medium	Partner
C-01	**The footfall version of the adjacency thesis is unsupported**	Low	DGTL
E-01	**Master stakes in lieu of cash have no published success rate**	Medium	DGTL
F-01	**DGTL's brand is front-loaded onto an unconfirmed venture**	Medium	DGTL

The 6 Critical findings. The full set is detailed in Section 04.

SECTION 02

Scope & Method

What was reviewed. The building and unit record for 20 Maud Street across three commercial listing platforms and the landlord's own marketing copy; the internal Strashin tenant roll and its lower-level unit assignments; the public web presence of the adjacent tenant (archivethreads.ca, maudst.ca) and its press coverage from April 2024 to January 2026; fifteen Toronto-area commercial studios and their published or absent rate cards; Canadian rights-collection bodies and their 2025–26 restructuring; Dolby, Apple and Spotify's own published positions on immersive audio; Ontario and federal production statistics and grant programmes; and the published record on commercial studio economics, utilization and failure.

Method. Manual source inspection and search-result review through the approved web-fetch tooling, conducted 10 August 2026, across four parallel research lanes. Every claim in this document resolves to a row in Appendix A. Where a source is a self-claim rather than a third-party finding, it is labelled as such in the finding.

Explicitly out of scope, and why.

- **The operator.** No identifying information was supplied. Category A is therefore an intake register rather than an assessment — the honest form of the finding.
- **The unit itself.** No site visit, no measurement, no acoustic or mechanical survey. Ceiling height, slab detail and structural noise are unknown.
- **Lease documents and the landlord's position.** Not obtained. Availability of B3 is inferred from a tenant roll and from the absence of a listing, not confirmed by Strashin.
- **The neighbour's intentions.** No conversation with 20 Maud is on record. Their retired services layer is inferred from the disappearance of pages from their own sites.
- **Anything requiring credentials.** Booking history, financial records, equipment finance position, domain registrar accounts, and any analytics.
- **Live social metrics.** Instagram blocks unauthenticated inspection; the only sourced follower figures for the neighbour are eighteen months old and are not relied upon here.

> THE CONSEQUENCE, STATED PLAINLY
>
> This audit can say with confidence **what is unestablished** and **what the published record does and does not support**. It cannot say whether this particular operator can fill this particular room, because the two facts that would answer that — who he is and whether the room exists — are both open. No traffic figure, ranking position, booking volume or revenue estimate appears anywhere in this document, because none was measured.

SECTION 03

Venture Architecture

The proposal has no website and no funnel to map, so the equivalent exercise is to draw where value and money would actually move, and to mark which nodes exist today. Read left to right within each row.

NODE 1 · EXISTS

The signal chain. Recording, mixing and mastering equipment, owned outright by the operator. Asserted, not inventoried — see A-02.

NODE 2 · UNBUILT

The room. Unit B3, lower level, 20 Maud Street. Recorded as occupied; no below-grade vacancy listed; no rate published; unmeasured — B-01, B-03, B-04.

NODE 3 · UNBUILT

The lease. Signed by the operator. Term is the dominant risk in the whole structure — B-02.

NODE 4 · MONEY NODE

Engine One — billable hours. Toronto band \$500–\$1,500 per day, ten-hour day, fifty percent deposit. Break-even at 100–150 billable hours a month — D-01, D-02.

NODE 5 · MONEY NODE

Engine Two — rights. Registration, mechanicals, neighbouring rights, sync. Switch-on cost under CAD \$300 in year one — E-02, E-03.

NODE 6 · UNBUILT

DGTL Records equity. Master stakes taken in lieu of cash. No published success rate; base rate makes it a lottery — E-01.

NODE 7 · INBOUND, REAL

The operator's referral network. The only acquisition channel operators report works. Unverified here — A-03.

NODE 8 · INBOUND, GATED

DGTL-originated work. Real pipeline; no attribution definition, no share defined, no memo — F-02.

NODE 9 · ADVERTISED, EMPTY

Adjacency footfall. No supporting evidence exists anywhere. The referral version of this node is real; the footfall version is not — C-01, C-02.

NODE 10 · UNBUILT

Brand, site, booking, deposits. DGTL's strongest seat. Blocked on names and domains that have not been cleared — F-03.

NODE 11 · NOT PROPOSED

Settlement rails. Deliberately closed at this stage. Merchant of record inherits dispute liability — F-04.

NODE 12 · EXPOSURE

The DGTL name on the door. Brand risk sits with DGTL; legal control of room and gear sits with the operator — F-01.

Gold border = money moves through this node · Dashed border = advertised or assumed but not yet built · Plain border = exists or is structural

ARCHITECTURE READ

Three of the four money nodes are real and two of them are cheap. Engine Two — registering the existing catalogue — requires no room, no lease and no build, costs under three hundred dollars, and can start this week. It is the only part of the venture with no dependency on any open finding, and it is the natural first proof of the partnership.

The structural problem is that the two nodes carrying the most weight in the pitch — the room and the adjacency — are the two least established, while the node carrying the most exposure — the DGTL name — is the one furthest from DGTL's control.

SECTION 04

Findings

23 findings across six categories. Category D is included because the demand backdrop is genuinely healthy and a document that only records risk misrepresents the opportunity. Category C contains one supportive finding — the version of the adjacency thesis that the evidence does support. Severity reflects what DGTL would inherit on attaching its name, not effort to fix.

Category A · The Operator

The individual who would hold the lease, own the gear and perform the work. Three findings.

A-01 CRITICAL

No assessment of the proposed operator has been possible.

OBSERVATION	DGTL has been asked to attach its brand, its client pipeline and a label imprint to a venture whose principal has not been named to this review. No legal name, operating entity, trading history, credit list, client roster, website or social footprint was supplied. Every other finding in this document concerns the room, the market or the rights; this one concerns the person, and it is the only one that cannot be resolved by research.
EVIDENCE	`Intake gap — no operator identifiers provided at commissioning, 2026-08-10.`
IMPACT	Partner fit cannot be rated. DGTL would be underwriting delivery risk on an unassessed counterparty. This finding gates every other recommendation in Section 06.
RECOMMENDATION	Supply legal name, operating entity (or confirmation that none exists), five years of credits, three referenceable clients, and any public profile. Re-run Category A before any DGTL-branded asset is produced.

EFFORT **LOW — ONE CONVERSATION** | OWNER **PARTNER**

NOTE *This is rated Critical on exposure, not on suspicion. The absence of the record is the finding; nothing adverse has been observed because nothing has been observable.*

A-02 HIGH

Equipment ownership is asserted but not inventoried or unencumbered.

OBSERVATION	The premise of the venture is that the operator already owns a full recording, mixing and mastering complement, so capital expenditure falls on the room rather than the signal chain. No schedule of equipment, no purchase records and no financing or lien position have been produced.
EVIDENCE	`Intake gap — no equipment schedule provided, 2026-08-10.`
IMPACT	The single largest asset contribution to the partnership is unverified. Financed or leased equipment carries repossession risk that would strand a lease already signed.
RECOMMENDATION	Request a dated equipment schedule with serial numbers for anything above $2,000, and a written statement that the listed items are owned outright and unencumbered. Attach it as a schedule to any partnership memo.

EFFORT **LOW** | OWNER **PARTNER**

A-03 HIGH

No verified credit list, and referral is the only acquisition channel operators report works.

OBSERVATION Commercial studio operators interviewed on the record are close to unanimous that bookings come from word of mouth and prior work, not from location, signage or advertising. One operator states plainly that outside a handful of destination rooms, clients book an engineer rather than a facility. The operator's reputation is therefore the demand model — and it has not been examined.

EVIDENCE `soundonsound.com/music-business/running-commercial-studio (June 2023); gearspace.com/threads/how-to-attract-new-clients-to-your-studio.1251890/ (2019-02-25).`

IMPACT Without a credit list there is no basis for the utilization assumption in D-01, and no basis for pricing DGTL's share of originated work.

RECOMMENDATION Obtain a discography or credit list and identify how many of the last twenty sessions came from repeat clients. That ratio, not the room, is the business.

EFFORT **LOW** | OWNER **PARTNER**

Category B · The Room and the Lease

The physical unit, its availability, its cost and its fitness for purpose. Five findings.

B-01 CRITICAL

Unit B3 is recorded as occupied, and no lower-level vacancy at 20 Maud is publicly listed.

OBSERVATION The target unit for this venture is B3, a lower-level unit at 20 Maud Street. The landlord's own tenant record lists B3 as held by an individual leaseholder in the makers group, in the building since 2024. Independently, the only vacancies advertised at 20 Maud are Suite 100 on the main floor (4,541 SF) and Suite 302 on the third floor (1,329 SF). No below-grade unit appears on any listing platform, at any rate.

EVIDENCE `Strashin tenant roll, unit B3 (lower level); loopnet.com/Listing/20-Maud-St-Toronto-ON/33753707/ (on market 2026-03-30); spacelist.ca listings 965740 and 975000 (updated 2026-07-16 and 2026-08-10).`

IMPACT The pitch is anchored on a unit that may not be available. If B3 cannot be released, the adjacency argument — which is the whole reason for this building — weakens materially, because Suite 302 is three floors above Archive Threads and shares nothing but an address.

RECOMMENDATION Confirm B3's status directly with Strashin (Daniel Glick, property management, Suite 500 in the same building) before the pitch is sent. If B3 is committed, ask specifically what lower-level inventory exists and on what notice. Treat Suite 302 as a different proposition, not a fallback.

EFFORT **LOW — ONE CALL** | OWNER **DGTL**

NOTE *The pitch page ships with the unit number as a data-slot for exactly this reason. It can be changed in one edit.*

B-02 CRITICAL

Lease term is the dominant risk in the venture, and it is the one nobody negotiates hard enough.

OBSERVATION The best-evidenced pattern in the commercial-studio record is that rooms close because of rent and land value, not because of demand. A Toronto precedent sits two years back: Josh Korody's Candle closed in 2022 over rising rent, and he rebuilt in the west end in 2025 as a smaller room with no large live space. Fifty buildings were demolished on Nashville's Music Row between 2013 and 2019, thirty-eight of them music-related. A studio that makes a building desirable is structurally the party most likely to be priced out of the value it creates.

EVIDENCE `exclaim.ca/music/article/torontos_candle_recording_studio_closes_due_to_rising_rent (2022-10-25); exclaim.ca/music/article/josh-korody-opens-new-studio-in-toronto-s-west-end (2025-10-14); savingplaces.org/places/nashvilles-music-row/updates/the-way-forward-for-music-row (2019-05-31).`

IMPACT A three-year term on a below-grade unit that has absorbed six figures of isolation and treatment is a wasting asset. The improvement is immovable and accrues to the landlord.

RECOMMENDATION Negotiate term before rate. Target five years with a renewal option at a capped escalation, and treat any fixturing or free-rent period as a term concession rather than a discount. Comparable creative tenants transact on three to five years; 20 Maud Suite 302 is advertised at one to ten.

EFFORT **MEDIUM — NEGOTIATION** | OWNER **PARTNER, DGTL ADVISES**

B-03 HIGH

No rate is published for any lower-level unit at 20 Maud; the only anchors are above-grade.

OBSERVATION

Strashin publishes $26.00 per square foot net plus $19.00 TMI — $45.00 gross — for Suite 100 on the main floor, and the same $26.00 net for Suite 302. Nothing is published for the lower level, and no below-grade rent discount for Toronto's downtown west submarket appears in any accessible source.

EVIDENCE

`gitalis.com/listing/20-maud-street-toronto/ (brochure 2026-04-02); loopnet.com Listing 33753707. Context: CBRE Toronto Downtown Office Figures Q2 2026, Downtown West net asking $33.49, vacancy 25.2%.`

IMPACT

Every rent figure in the model is an inference from an above-grade comparable. The occupancy cost of the venture is not yet known to within a usable margin.

RECOMMENDATION

Ask for the lower-level rate in writing. A 25.2% vacancy rate in Downtown West is the negotiating position; use it.

EFFORT **LOW** | OWNER **DGTL**

B-04 HIGH

The unit's physical fitness for recording has not been measured, and the ceiling is the binding constraint.

OBSERVATION

The building is Class C brick-and-beam, built between 1910 and 1935, with published ceilings of twelve feet unfinished and ten feet finished. Floated floors and isolated ceilings typically consume eight to fourteen inches of that. Dolby's published minimum finished floor-to-overhead height for an Atmos room is 2.4 metres. Mechanical noise is the other constraint: ASHRAE specifies NC 15–20 for a recording studio, which is a critical monitoring environment, and no noise survey of the unit exists.

EVIDENCE

`loopnet.com Listing 33753707 (building spec); professionalsupport.dolby.com – Dolby Atmos Home Entertainment Studio Technical Guidelines (updated 2026-02-17); ASHRAE Handbook Ch. 48 Table 1.`

IMPACT

If the finished ceiling lands below 2.4 metres after isolation, the Atmos line of the business is closed before it opens — and Atmos is the only part of the offer with a documented royalty premium attached to it (E-04).

RECOMMENDATION

Before signing: measure slab-to-deck clearance, identify the structure above, and commission a two-hour acoustic and mechanical walk-through. Budget the survey, not the remediation — remediation cost is the answer the survey produces.

EFFORT **MEDIUM** | OWNER **PARTNER, DGTL ADVISES**

B-05 MEDIUM

Build-out is uncosted, and the published Toronto benchmarks span a factor of four.

OBSERVATION

Turner & Townsend's Canadian cost guide puts a Toronto commercial fit-out at CA$235 to $395 per square foot for medium quality and $475 to $865 for high quality, hard cost, excluding tax, consultants, permits, FF&E and contingency. Soundproofing labour alone in the GTA runs $2.90 to $5.20 per square foot at market rate. Toronto construction escalation ran above five percent year over year through 2025.

EVIDENCE

`marketintelligence.turnerandtownsend.com – Canada Annual Cost Guide (Jan 2025); renovationprice.ca/soundproofing-costs-in-toronto-gta/ (2026-02-27); rlb.com Canada construction cost reports Q2–Q4 2025.`

IMPACT

The spread between the low and high benchmark is larger than the likely first-year revenue of the room. A build priced off the wrong end of it decides the venture.

RECOMMENDATION

Price the build from a drawing, not a benchmark. Get two fixed-price quotes against a measured unit before the lease is signed, and make the lease conditional on them where the landlord will allow it.

EFFORT **MEDIUM** | OWNER **PARTNER**

Category C · The Adjacency Thesis

Whether proximity to 20 Maud / Archive Threads actually produces business. Three findings, one of them supportive.

C-01 CRITICAL

The footfall version of the adjacency thesis is unsupported by anything in the public record.

OBSERVATION Two independent research passes found no case, anywhere, of a commercial recording studio attributing new business to a neighbouring retail destination, and no brand has ever published a sales, footfall or revenue figure attributable to an in-store recording studio. The brand-studio record is a graveyard: Converse Rubber Tracks (opened 2011, Boston site closed to local bands 2017, Brooklyn permanently closed), Red Bull's eleven-studio network (shuttered July 2020), House of Vans London (closed December 2022). All were marketing-funded and none sold hours. Meanwhile every Toronto studio that has to bill hours — Noble Street, Revolution, Union Sound, Dream House — sits in a cheap industrial conversion, and all of them are still open.

EVIDENCE `digiday.com/marketing/inside-rubber-tracks-converses-contribution-music-community/ (2015-08-31); musicbusinessworldwide.com — Red Bull studio network closure (July 2020); nme.com/news/music/london-house-of-vans-venue-to-close-after-eight-years-3354555 (2022).`

IMPACT If the pitch is sold on walk-in trade or borrowed footfall, it is being sold on a claim with no supporting evidence and a visible pattern of failure behind it. That is a reputational exposure for DGTL, not merely a weak argument.

RECOMMENDATION Remove every footfall claim from all client-facing material. The pitch page already carries a "What We're Not Claiming" section stating this in plain terms — keep it, and do not let it be edited out.

EFFORT **LOW — EDITORIAL** | OWNER **DGTL**

NOTE *High-end studios market the opposite: Westlake advertises covert private entrances and reserved parking, and sells discretion. A below-grade room beside an appointment-only showroom satisfies that requirement well — but the reason it works is privacy, which is an argument against selling it on visibility.*

C-02 MEDIUM

The referral version of the thesis is supported, and it is the version worth pitching.

OBSERVATION Two mechanisms survive scrutiny. First, peer proximity: the one operator on record who credits location credits being surrounded by other music-makers, and pairs it immediately with networking. Second, the acquisition path 20 Maud has actually demonstrated — the costume designer for Crave's Heated Rivalry found them by searching online, discovered their Instagram, and booked an appointment. That is a referral network with a curated inbound flow of working artists, stylists and production departments, and referral is the only channel studio operators say works.

EVIDENCE `theglobeandmail.com — Heated Rivalry costume feature (2026-01-04); soundonsound.com/music-business/running-commercial-studio (June 2023).`

IMPACT This is the honest, defensible case for the building, and it is a better case than the one being replaced: shared audience and joint programming rather than borrowed footfall.

RECOMMENDATION Build the pitch on shared audience and joint programming. Studio-hosted events are separately documented as converting to bookings — that is a programme the two tenants can run together, and it is the concrete thing to propose.

EFFORT **LOW — POSITIONING** | OWNER **DGTL**

C-03 HIGH

The neighbour's services layer — including a photography studio and twelve hours of studio time — was announced in 2024 and is now absent from both of their websites.

OBSERVATION At launch in April 2024, 20 Maud advertised tiered monthly memberships at $350 to $700 including rentals, styling, access to a photography studio and twelve hours of studio time at the top tier, plus monthly community events. As of 10 August 2026 neither maudst.ca nor archivethreads.ca carries a memberships page, a photography-studio offer, a styling-services page, or an events calendar. Navigation is four items: Home, Shop, Book an Appointment, Rental.

EVIDENCE `streetsoftoronto.com/toronto-culture/20-maud-archive-fashion-shop-toronto/ (2024-04-26); maudst.ca and archivethreads.ca observed 2026-08-10.`

IMPACT Read pessimistically, they tried a studio and services layer and it did not stick. Read opportunistically, they identified real demand — stylists needing pulls and a shoot space in one place — and have vacated the delivery of it. Both readings change the pitch, and no partnership conversation with them is on record.

RECOMMENDATION Ask them directly before the pitch is sent. This is a fifteen-minute conversation that determines whether the adjacency is a partnership or a coincidence.

EFFORT **LOW — ONE CONVERSATION** | OWNER **PARTNER OR DGTL**

Category D · Market, Demand and Break-Even

Whether the room can fill, at what rate, in what market. Four findings, including a healthy one.

D-01 HIGH

Break-even is a utilization problem, and no booking evidence has been produced.

OBSERVATION The published benchmark for a commercial room is that the rate must cover personal and business costs at fifty percent utilization — roughly 140 to 150 billable hours a month, or three and a half days a week. A conservative floor is 100 billable hours a month. The same source advises against opening at all unless the operator can start at approximately fifty percent of capacity. No forward booking evidence, pipeline or letter of intent exists for this venture.

EVIDENCE `sonicscoop.com/should-recording-studios-advertise-their-rates-and-how-much-should-they-charge/ (Justin Colletti, 2017-02-05).`

IMPACT The venture would open with a fixed occupancy cost, an amortising build and an empty calendar. That is the documented failure mode, and it is the one that closes rooms even when the work is good.

RECOMMENDATION Before the lease is signed, convert the operator's existing client list into committed hours — even soft commitments. If the answer is below fifty hours a month, the honest recommendation is to defer, not to build cheaper.

EFFORT **MEDIUM** | OWNER **PARTNER**

D-02 MEDIUM

Rate opacity is the market norm and makes pricing a matter of primary quotes, not desk research.

OBSERVATION Of fifteen Toronto-area studios checked directly, one published a rate range and six returned no retrievable content. Union Sound Company states the norm in writing and puts the Toronto commercial band at $500 to $1,500 per day on a ten-hour day with a fifty percent deposit, placing itself in the lower half. One published Toronto card exists in full — Private Ear Recording's 2026 rates — and it is the only usable anchor for post and audio-for-picture work.

EVIDENCE `unionsoundcompany.com/frequently-asked-questions; privateearrecording.com/rates (2026).`

IMPACT Any pro-forma built on "market rate" is built on one data point. Rate positioning has to come from calls, not from the web.

RECOMMENDATION Call three comparable rooms for a quote before setting a card. Publish a rate — the opacity is an opportunity, and the one Toronto room that publishes is the one this venture can most usefully be benchmarked against.

EFFORT **LOW** | OWNER **PARTNER**

D-03 MEDIUM

The room would have no studio neighbours; Toronto's studio geography is elsewhere.

OBSERVATION Toronto's commercial recording capacity sits in Parkdale (Noble Street), Corktown (Union Sound), Leslieville (Revolution and postRevolution), Scarborough (Phase One) and Mississauga (Metalworks). The nearest comparable to 20 Maud is Desert Fish at 401 Richmond Street West, a lower-level room about one kilometre away running Dolby Atmos 9.1.4 and a full voice, ADR, game and post stack. Grayson Music opened a three-studio music-and-post hub in the fashion district in February 2026.

EVIDENCE `desertfishstudios.com; newswire.ca — Grayson Music launch (2026-02-24).`

IMPACT The Fashion District is not a studio cluster, and one credible competitor opened in it six months ago. Framing the location as "joining a cluster" would be inaccurate; framing it as differentiation is defensible.

RECOMMENDATION Position on differentiation and on the neighbour relationship, not on cluster effects. Treat Desert Fish and Grayson as the competitive set and price against them.

EFFORT **LOW — POSITIONING** | OWNER **DGTL**

D-04 LOW

The demand backdrop is healthy — included because it is, and because the rest of this section is not.

OBSERVATION

Ontario film and television production reached $2.70 billion in 2025, up 5.7 percent across 363 productions and 35,268 full-time-equivalent jobs. National sound-recording studio revenue rose 10.2 percent to $169.0 million. Canadian recorded music grew 5.6 percent to $957.9 million, with synchronisation revenue up 11.0 percent to $13.8 million. Toronto counts 85 listed recording studios, 75 labels, more than 60 publishing and licensing companies and over 18,000 SOCAN creators.

EVIDENCE

`ontariocreates.ca — 2025 Film and Television Production Statistics (filed 2026-03-30); statcan.gc.ca table 21-10-0055-01 (ref. 2023); musiccanada.com — IFPI Global Music Report 2026 (2026-03-18); toronto.ca — Music Industry Strategy 2022–2026.`

IMPACT

The market is growing and the post-production demand is real. Nothing in this document argues the sector is shrinking; the risks are all local to this venture.

RECOMMENDATION

Use these figures in client-facing material — they are the strongest sourced numbers available and they belong in the pitch.

EFFORT **NONE** | OWNER **DGTL**

Category E · Rights, Registration and DGTL Records

The publishing and label arm proposed alongside the room. Four findings.

E-01 CRITICAL

Taking master stakes in lieu of cash has no published success rate, and the base rate makes it a lottery priced in unbilled studio days.

OBSERVATION

The industry has never measured the outcome of spec or "studio for points" arrangements; no hit rate is published anywhere. What is published is the earnings distribution beneath it: the hundred-thousandth-highest-earning artist on Spotify made just over $7,300 in 2025. Spotify represents roughly thirty percent of global recorded revenue, so an all-platform figure for that artist is in the low tens of thousands. A three-point stake in that release is worth a few hundred dollars a year. Practitioners on record describe unrecouped balances, liens that are impractical to enforce, and one reporting fifteen thousand dollars of uncollected production fees.

EVIDENCE

`loudandclear.byspotify.com/takeaways/ (modified 2026-03-11); gearspace.com/board/audio-student-engineering-production-question-zone/1110478-studio-owning-masters.html (September 2016); blog.discmakers.com/2020/11/music-producer-points/ (2020-11-19).`

IMPACT

If DGTL Records takes master stakes in exchange for studio time, DGTL is trading billable capacity — the only reliably monetisable asset in the venture — for an unpriced option. Compounding this, FACTOR's business policies require notice and approval before any transfer of interest in a funded recording, and a transfer to a non-Canadian label triggers immediate one-hundred-percent repayment.

RECOMMENDATION

Do not make points the default. Where a stake is taken, cap it, define the royalty base explicitly (points on suggested retail price and points on published price to dealer are not the same number), and write a reversion trigger. Screen every candidate release against FACTOR's transfer rules before signing.

EFFORT **MEDIUM — LEGAL** | OWNER **DGTL**

NOTE *DGTL is not a law firm and this is not legal advice. Any points structure should be reviewed by counsel before it is offered to a first artist.*

E-02 HIGH

Canada's collection landscape changed twice in eighteen months; any advice from pre-2025 sources is wrong.

OBSERVATION

MROC has wound down and transferred its remaining mandates to ARTISTI. Connect Music Licensing terminated all agency agreements effective 1 January 2025 and now represents major labels only. SOPROQ was renamed Panorama on 15 September 2025 and is now the collective for independent master owners in Canada — and the issuer of ISRC registrant codes, although IFPI's own contact list still names Connect. SOCAN announced an agreement to acquire CMRRA on 29 July 2026.

EVIDENCE

`resound.ca — 2024 Annual Report; connectmusic.ca FAQ (updated 2025-10-29); panorama.mu/en/faq; socan.com — SOCAN/SoundExchange announcement (2026-07-29).`

IMPACT

A label arm registering repertoire against the pre-2025 map would file with bodies that no longer accept it, and would miss neighbouring-rights income entirely.

RECOMMENDATION

Register through the current map: SOCAN as writer and publisher, then either SOCAN Reproduction Rights or CMRRA but never both, Panorama for neighbouring rights, ACTRA RACS per performer, SoundExchange for United States digital, and the MLC through one route only.

EFFORT **LOW — ADMINISTRATIVE** | OWNER **DGTL**

E-03 MEDIUM

The registration barrier is administrative, not financial — which is why leaving it undone is the expensive choice.

OBSERVATION
Setting up a label's rights infrastructure properly costs under CAD $300 in year one. SoundExchange, the MLC, ISNI and ISWC registration are free; a SOCAN publisher account is a one-time fee; the only recurring cost is a GS1 Canada barcode licence, whose individual tier is $26.25 a year for businesses under $250,000 in revenue. ISRCs are free through a distributor, or through a Panorama registrant prefix if the label wants its own.

EVIDENCE
`gs1ca.org/small-business/; themlc.com/membership; soundcredit.com/isni-registration; panorama.mu/en/get-an-isrc.`

IMPACT
Every unregistered master the operator has already recorded is earning nothing and has been earning nothing for as long as it has existed. That backlog is the cheapest asset in the venture and it requires no room, no lease and no build.

RECOMMENDATION
Register the existing catalogue first, before the lease is signed. It is the one piece of the plan that can start this week and it is the proof-of-work that de-risks everything else.

EFFORT **LOW** | OWNER **DGTL**

E-04 MEDIUM

Dolby does not certify Atmos music studios, two local competitors imply otherwise, and only Apple pays a premium.

OBSERVATION
Dolby's Atmos music studio directory is a self-submission list; there is no certification or approval programme for music, and the cinema certification is a separate thing entirely. Two Toronto-area rooms currently describe themselves as "approved" or "authorized" for Atmos music. On payout: Apple Music states that Spatial Audio content receives a greater share of sound-recording royalties, "by a rate of up to 10%", counting any stream of a Spatial-available track regardless of device — conditional on the mix coming from multitracks or stems, with upmixing and stem-extraction disallowed. Spotify has no Atmos tier at all; its quality ladder tops out at lossless stereo.

EVIDENCE
`professional.dolby.com/music/dolby-atmos-music-studios; artists.apple.com/support/5477-elevate-sound-spatial-audio-dolby-atmos; support.spotify.com/us/article/audio-quality/ (all observed 2026-08-10).`

IMPACT
Atmos is the only line of the offer with a documented royalty premium attached, and it is also the one where a false claim is easiest to make and easiest to catch.

RECOMMENDATION
Never describe a DGTL room as Dolby-certified or approved for music. State the configuration and the room dimensions instead. Quote the Apple figure precisely as "up to 10%" and always state the Spotify position alongside it.

EFFORT **LOW — EDITORIAL** | OWNER **DGTL**

Category F · What DGTL Would Inherit

Reputational and contractual exposure created by attaching the DGTL name. Four findings.

F-01 CRITICAL

The proposal front-loads DGTL's brand onto a venture whose principal and premises are both unconfirmed.

OBSERVATION	The agreed structure is that the operator signs the lease and owns the gear, while the public identity is DGTL Studios and DGTL Records. That means the party carrying the delivery risk in the market's eyes is DGTL, and the party carrying the legal control of the room and the equipment is not.
EVIDENCE	`Structure as briefed, 2026-08-10; unresolved findings A-01 and B-01.`
IMPACT	If the room does not open, opens late, or opens and fails, the failure is branded DGTL and the assets walk. DGTL would hold the reputational downside without the operating control that would let it manage the outcome.
RECOMMENDATION	Either move the public identity to a co-brand that survives a separation, or take a contractual seat proportionate to the brand exposure — a naming licence terminable on defined events, with a wind-down clause covering how the DGTL marks come off the door, the site and the socials.

EFFORT **MEDIUM — LEGAL** | OWNER **DGTL**

F-02 HIGH

No written partnership memo exists, and the revenue share is described but not defined.

OBSERVATION	DGTL is to provide brand, website and booking system, client pipeline, and the label back end, in exchange for a revenue share or fee on originated work. Nothing defines what "originated" means, how it is attributed, what happens to a client who arrives through DGTL and returns directly, or how the build fee for the brand and site is treated if the venture folds in year one.
EVIDENCE	`Structure as briefed, 2026-08-10; no memo produced.`
IMPACT	Attribution disputes are the standard failure mode of referral partnerships between friends, and they surface at exactly the point the venture starts working.
RECOMMENDATION	Write a two-page memo before anything is built: definition of originated work, attribution window, treatment of repeat clients, build-fee treatment on early termination, and an explicit statement that DGTL has no claim on the operator's pre-existing clients.

EFFORT **LOW** | OWNER **BOTH**

F-03 HIGH

Six domains are proposed and none has been confirmed as registered, held or clearable.

OBSERVATION	The concept brief lists therecordstore.ca, brainstore.ca, brstr.co, dgtl.services, dgtl.audio and dgtl.video. Registration status, ownership and renewal position are unconfirmed for all six, and no trademark clearance has been performed on any of the proposed names.
EVIDENCE	`Concept brief supplied 2026-08-10; no registrar or CIPO records produced.`
IMPACT	Building a brand on a domain that is not held, or on a name that cannot be registered, converts design work into sunk cost. "The Record Store" in particular is descriptive and unlikely to be registrable as a bare word mark.
RECOMMENDATION	Confirm registrant and expiry on all six before any identity work begins. Run a CIPO knock-out search on the two names that would actually be used. Consolidate the rest or let them lapse.

EFFORT **LOW** | OWNER **DGTL**

F-04 MEDIUM

No DGTL Pay or settlement seat is proposed here, and none should be opened at this stage.

OBSERVATION	The venture would take deposits — a fifty percent deposit is the Toronto norm — and could plausibly route them through DGTL rails. Studio deposits are a low-dispute product, but the volume is small and the counterparty is unassessed.
EVIDENCE	`unionsoundcompany.com/frequently-asked-questions (deposit norm); finding A-01.`
IMPACT	Whoever holds the merchant relationship inherits the dispute rate, the chargeback liability and the contagion risk that follows a merchant onto a processor blacklist. A single-room studio does not generate the volume to justify that exposure.
RECOMMENDATION	Do not open a settlement seat in phase one. Revisit only after twelve months of trading history, and then only on the lowest-risk self-serve line, priced and capped, with counsel review. DGTL is not a law firm and this is not legal advice.

EFFORT **NONE — DECISION** | OWNER **DGTL**

SECTION 05

Market Context & the Break-Even Question

This section replaces the competitive-context section of a client audit. The question is not whether the sector is attractive — D-04 establishes that it is — but whether the specific claim underneath this venture, that a room in this building can fill, is plausible against what the market publishes.

COMPARABLE SET

ROOM	LOCATION & GRADE	POSITION	RATES PUBLISHED
Desert Fish	401 Richmond St W, Suite B102 — lower level, ~1 km away	The direct comparable. Atmos 9.1.4, Sony 360RA, full VO / ADR / audiobook / game / post stack, film score mixing.	No
Grayson Music	Fashion District — opened February 2026	Three commercial studios, writing rooms, vinyl bar, stage, coworking. Music plus full audio post. The newest and closest competitive threat.	No
Noble Street	17 Noble St, Parkdale — purpose-built	Four rooms, 1,200 sq ft live room, SSL. Destination tracking.	No
Revolution / postRevolution	36 Laing St, Leslieville — 8,500 sq ft	Three rooms; the fullest post stack in the city — radio, ad, sound design, foley, ADR, audiobooks, gaming.	No
Union Sound Company	89 Sackville St, Corktown — 2,400 sq ft	Tracking on a 1971 Neve. The only room that publishes the market band.	Band only
Private Ear	Toronto	Two rooms plus live. The only full published card in the city.	Yes — 2026

Of fifteen Toronto-area studios checked directly, one published a full rate card and six returned no retrievable content. This section is qualitative: it reflects what was publicly visible on one day, from one location.

PLAUSIBILITY READ — QUALITATIVE

The published break-even benchmark is fifty percent utilization, roughly 140 to 150 billable hours a month, with 100 hours as a conservative floor — and the same source advises against opening unless the operator can *start* near fifty percent. Against a Toronto day-rate band of $500 to $1,500, that is the entire question. It is not a question research can answer. It is answered by the operator's existing client list, which has not been produced (A-03), and by the occupancy cost of a unit whose rate is not published (B-03).

What can be said: the two nearest comparables both lead with *post-production*, not music tracking, and Ontario production spend grew 5.7 percent to $2.70 billion in 2025 while Canadian sync grew 11.0 percent. If this room is going to fill, the published evidence points at audio for picture — foley, ADR, dialogue, sound design, mix-to-picture — more strongly than at album work. That is also the seat where DGTL is a buyer rather than a marketer.

CATEGORY RISK REGISTER

RISK	WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	BEARS ON
Rent and land value	The dominant documented cause of studio closure. A local precedent two years old (Candle, 2022) and a national one (50 buildings demolished on Music Row, 2013–2019). Improvements to a below-grade unit are immovable.	B-02
Grant ineligibility	Recording studios are the first item on the Ontario Arts Council's ineligible-applicant list. Public money routes through the artist — OAC pays up to $10,000 for an album and counts studio rental as an eligible cost. The room's role is vendor, not applicant.	D-04

Immersive-audio claims	No certification exists for Atmos music studios; two local rooms imply otherwise. Apple pays up to ten percent more for Spatial; Spotify pays nothing. A false claim here is trivially checkable.	E-04
Generative AI in library and sync	CISAC / PMP projects generative AI reaching roughly sixty percent of music-library revenues by 2028, with about a quarter of creators' revenues at risk. Deezer reported AI tracks exceeding half of daily uploads in June 2026.	E-01
Streaming base rates	Blended indie payouts are flat to declining. Spotify's hundred-thousandth-ranked artist earned just over $7,300 in 2025. Any plan whose upside rests on streaming income is resting on that distribution.	E-01
Creative-space displacement	Toronto lost multiple creative spaces through 2025 — 379 Adelaide St W terminated early, It's OK* Studios vacating, Velvet Underground closed. The City's Culture Connects plan promises a million square feet of new cultural space over ten years; none of it is committed to this venture.	B-02

SECTION 06

Partnership Fit — Where DGTL Plugs In

Seven candidate seats, each rated on the evidence rather than on enthusiasm. Two are strong and neither of them depends on the adjacency argument being true. Three are gated. Two should stay closed.

1. Audio post and Atmos delivery for DGTL's own production work STRONG FIT

DGTL already ships film, campaign and documentary content — the Epidemic Sound cinematic film, the Swae Lee day-in-the-life, the Lil Tjay live recap, the Canon and Anker campaigns. All of it needs mix, sound design and increasingly Atmos deliverables, and all of it is currently bought outside. This seat is DGTL buying hours it already spends, from a room it helped build.

EVIDENCE brand-facts.md — verified DGTL case studies; privateearrecording.com/rates (published Toronto post rates: foley $100/hr or $1,000/day; sound design and scoring plus mix $800 per minute of finished output).

2. Website, booking system and commerce STRONG FIT

The closest match in DGTL's verified record: The 400 Market rebuild — Next.js 15 and React 19 on Payload CMS, Stripe with webhook order sync, bidirectional CRM sync, marketing automation, ten-plus integrations, 90/91 Lighthouse. A studio booking and deposit flow is a strict subset of that build. The preceding engagement lifted mobile Lighthouse from 45 to 86 and doubled organic traffic in twelve months.

EVIDENCE brand-facts.md — The 400 Market, 2025 and 2026.

3. Brand identity and content GATED FIT

Within capability and squarely in DGTL's service set. Gated only because the identity would be built on names and domains that have not been cleared, and because the public identity currently proposed puts DGTL's mark on a third party's premises.

EVIDENCE Gated by F-01 and F-03.

4. Client pipeline into the room GATED FIT

DGTL Influence runs 80+ vetted creators with 350M+ combined reach across 60+ campaigns, and DGTL's own productions generate recurring audio need. The flow is real. What is not defined is how an originated booking is attributed, priced and shared, and there is no basis yet for forecasting volume against the 100-to-150 billable-hour benchmark.

EVIDENCE brand-facts.md — DGTL Influence network. Gated by D-01 and F-02.

5. DGTL Records — registration and rights administration GATED FIT

The administrative case is strong and cheap: under CAD $300 in year one to register properly, against a backlog of unregistered masters that is currently earning nothing. The equity case is not: master stakes taken in lieu of cash have no published success rate and a base-rate distribution that makes them a lottery. Split the seat — take the administration, defer the equity.

EVIDENCE Gated by E-01 and E-02. Supported by E-03.

6. DGTL Pay / settlement NO FIT

Not proposed and not appropriate at this stage. A single-room studio taking fifty-percent deposits does not generate volume that justifies inheriting dispute rate and chargeback liability on an unassessed counterparty.

EVIDENCE See F-04.

7. Capital participation in the build or the rent

NO FIT

No position should be taken until B-01 and B-02 clear. Improvements to a below-grade unit are immovable and accrue to the landlord; on a short term they are a wasting asset. This is the documented way studios die.

EVIDENCE See B-02.

GATING CONDITIONS

(a) Before any DGTL-branded asset ships publicly — before the pitch page goes to a live URL, before an identity is designed, before the DGTL name appears on a door, a site or a social account: A-01 (operator assessed), A-02 (equipment schedule received), B-01 (unit availability confirmed in writing by Strashin), F-03 (domains confirmed held and names knocked out) must all clear, and F-02 (a signed two-page memo) must exist.

(b) Before DGTL Records takes any master stake, or any settlement or DGTL Pay pilot is discussed: E-01 and E-02 must clear, F-04 stands as a decision to defer, and counsel must review the points structure. Settlement rule of thumb: whoever holds the merchant relationship inherits the dispute rate, the chargeback liability and processor-blacklist contagion. If a pilot is ever opened, open it on the lowest-risk self-serve line only, priced and capped. DGTL is not a law firm and none of this is legal advice.

(c) Before capital of any kind is committed to the build or the rent: B-02 (term negotiated) and B-04 (unit measured and surveyed) must clear. On a short term, a below-grade build is a gift to the landlord.

SECTION 07

Sequenced Roadmap

Four phases. No prices appear in this document — it is a diagnostic, and keeping commercial terms out of it is what lets it be read without a guard up. Finding IDs are rendered in gold so the table ties back to Section 04.

PHASE	WORKSTREAM	FINDINGS	OWNER	DEPENDENCY
Phase 0 · Verification Week 1–2	Three conversations and one document request. Landlord on B3; neighbour on their retired services layer; friend on identity, entity, credits and equipment. Domain and mark check.	A-01 A-02 A-03 B-01 B-03 C-03 F-03	Both	Gates every other phase
Phase 1 · Proof without premises Week 1–4, parallel	Register the existing catalogue against the current Canadian rights map. Under CAD $300, no room required. Establishes the working relationship before either party is exposed.	E-02 E-03	DGTL	None — start immediately
Phase 2 · Room and lease Week 3–8	Measure the unit, commission the acoustic and mechanical walk-through, obtain two fixed-price build quotes, then negotiate term before rate.	B-02 B-04 B-05	Partner, DGTL advises	Phase 0 closed
Phase 3 · Brand, site, pipeline Month 2–4	Identity, website, booking and deposit flow, rate card, positioning on post rather than footfall. Convert the operator's client list into committed hours before launch.	C-01 C-02 D-01 D-02 D-03 F-01 F-02	DGTL	Gate (a) cleared
Phase 4 · Rights equity Month 6+, gated hardest	Any master-stake structure, any settlement discussion. Deferred by default.	E-01 E-04 F-04	DGTL + counsel	Gate (b) cleared

SEQUENCING RATIONALE

Phase 0 is three phone calls and it can invalidate the entire venture, so it costs almost nothing and is worth more than everything after it. Phase 1 runs in parallel deliberately: it is the only workstream with no dependencies, it produces revenue from work already done, and it lets both parties find out how they work together before either has signed anything. Room and lease precede brand because a brand built for a unit that turns out to be unavailable is sunk cost, and because term negotiation is easier before a public commitment exists. Rights equity is last and gated hardest because it is the only element where DGTL trades a certain asset — billable capacity — for an uncertain one.

The order also protects the friendship, which is a real consideration and not a soft one. Every question in Phase 0 is easier to ask before money moves than after.

SECTION 08

Measurement Plan

Baseline must be captured before any Phase 3 asset ships. Capturing it afterwards makes the engagement unprovable — this is the second time that is stated in this document, deliberately.

METRIC	DEFINITION AND BASELINE	CADENCE	PROVES
Billable hours per month	Hours invoiced, against the published floor of 100 and the fifty-percent benchmark of 140–150. Baseline is the operator's current monthly hours before the room exists.	Monthly	D-01
Booking source attribution	Every booking tagged at intake: operator referral, DGTL-originated, neighbour or building referral, or inbound web. This is the only way the adjacency claim ever becomes measurable rather than argued.	Per booking	C-01 C-02 F-02
Occupancy cost ratio	Gross rent plus TMI as a share of monthly revenue. The number that predicts the documented failure mode.	Monthly	B-02 B-03
Catalogue registration completeness	Count of masters with ISRC, SOCAN, Panorama, MLC and SoundExchange registration complete, against total masters held. Baseline is almost certainly zero, which is the point.	Monthly to complete	E-02 E-03
Rights income received	Actual distributions by body. Note the lag structure: SOCAN quarterly, Panorama Canadian once a year in July, Re:Sound annually the year after broadcast. Do not read year one as a signal.	Quarterly	E-01 E-03
Post-production share of revenue	Audio-for-picture revenue as a share of total. Tests the Section 05 read that post, not album work, is where this room fills.	Quarterly	D-03

APPENDIX A

Sources & Evidence Log

WHAT WAS CHECKED	SOURCE	ACCESSED
Strashin tenant record — unit B3, lower level	internal tenant roll / brain vault	2026-08-10
20 Maud Street — Suite 302 listing, building spec	loopnet.com/Listing/20-Maud-St-Toronto-ON/33753707/	2026-08-10
20 Maud Street — Suite 100, $26.00 net + $19.00 TMI	gitalis.com/listing/20-maud-street-toronto/	2026-08-10
20 Maud Street — Suite 100 listings	spacelist.ca/listings/965740 and /975000	2026-08-10
Strashin Developments — portfolio, "new media studios" leasing copy	loopnet.com/company/strashin-developments/6pl1rxvl	2026-08-10
Archive Threads / 20 Maud — unit B2, appointment model, rental tiers	archivethreads.ca/pages/visit; maudst.ca/pages/rental	2026-08-10
20 Maud — launch memberships $350–$700, photography studio, events	streetsoftoronto.com/toronto-culture/20-maud-archive-fashion-shop-toronto/	2024-04-26
20 Maud — founder feature, follower figures, client roster claim	blogto.com/fashion_style/2025/02/20-maud-store-toronto/	2025-02
20 Maud — Heated Rivalry costume credit, Instagram-to-appointment path	theglobeandmail.com — Heated Rivalry costume feature	2026-01-04
Converse Rubber Tracks — marketing purpose stated by Converse	digiday.com/marketing/inside-rubber-tracks-converses-contribution-music-community/	2015-08-31
Red Bull — global studio network closure	musicbusinessworldwide.com — Red Bull studios	2020-07
House of Vans London — closure	nme.com/news/music/london-house-of-vans-venue-to-close-after-eight-years-3354555	2022
Studio acquisition channels — operator interviews	soundonsound.com/music-business/running-commercial-studio	2023-06
Studio client acquisition — practitioner thread	gearspace.com/threads/how-to-attract-new-clients-to-your-studio.1251890/	2019-02-25
Utilization and break-even benchmarks	sonicscoop.com/should-recording-studios-advertise-their-rates-and-how-much-should-they-charge/	2017-02-05
Toronto day-rate band, deposit norm, rate-opacity statement	unionsoundcompany.com/frequently-asked-questions	2026-08-10
Published Toronto rate card — tracking, mix, master, ADR, foley, sound design	privateearrecording.com/rates	2026-08-10
Nearest lower-level comparable — Atmos 9.1.4, full post stack	desertfishstudios.com	2026-08-10
Grayson Music — fashion-district music and post hub opening	newswire.ca — Grayson Music launch	2026-02-24
Candle studio closure over rising rent	exclaim.ca/music/article/torontos_candle_recording_studio_closes_due_to_rising_rent	2022-10-25

Deep Water Studio opening — same operator, smaller room	exclaim.ca/music/article/josh-korody-opens-new-studio-in-toronto-s-west-end	2025-10-14
Nashville Music Row demolitions	savingplaces.org/places/nashvilles-music-row/updates/the-way-forward-for-music-row	2019-05-31
Toronto commercial fit-out cost bands	marketintelligence.turnerandtownsend.com — Canada Annual Cost Guide	2025-01
GTA soundproofing labour rates	renovationprice.ca/soundproofing-costs-in-toronto-gta/	2026-02-27
Toronto construction escalation Q2–Q4 2025	rlb.com — Canada construction cost reports	2025
Downtown West office vacancy and net asking rent	cbre.ca/insights/figures/toronto-downtown-office-figures-q2-2026	2026-07-29
Dolby Atmos music studios — directory is self-submission	professional.dolby.com/music/dolby-atmos-music-studios	2026-08-10
Dolby Atmos room technical guidelines — 7.1.4, 2.4 m overhead	professionalsupport.dolby.com — Home Entertainment Studio Technical Guidelines	2026-02-17
Apple Music — Spatial Audio royalty share "up to 10%", mix-source rules	artists.apple.com/support/5477-elevate-sound-spatial-audio-dolby-atmos	2026-08-10
Spotify — quality ladder tops at lossless stereo, no Atmos tier	support.spotify.com/us/article/audio-quality/	2026-08-10
Spotify earnings distribution — 100,000th artist $7,300+	loudandclear.byspotify.com/takeaways/	2026-03-11
Spec / points arrangements — practitioner accounts	gearspace.com/board/audio-student-engineering-production-question-zone/1110478-studio-owning-masters.html	2016-09
Producer points conventions and royalty base	blog.discmakers.com/2020/11/music-producer-points/	2020-11-19
FACTOR business policies — transfer of interest, approval, repayment	factor.ca — Business Policies (PDF)	2025-08-26
MROC wind-down, Re:Sound membership	resound.ca — 2024 Annual Report	2025-06
Connect Music — agency agreements terminated, majors only	connectmusic.ca — Connect/SOPROQ FAQ	2025-10-29
SOPROQ renamed Panorama; ISRC issuance	panorama.mu/en/faq; panorama.mu/en/get-an-isrc	2026-08-10
SOCAN agreement to acquire CMRRA	socan.com — SOCAN / SoundExchange announcement	2026-07-29
GS1 Canada barcode licence tiers	gs1ca.org/small-business/	2026-08-10
MLC and ISNI registration — no fee	themlc.com/membership; soundcredit.com/isni-registration	2026-08-10
Ontario Arts Council — recording studios ineligible; eligible costs	arts.on.ca/grants/music-recording-projects	2026-08-10
Ontario film and television production 2025	ontariocreates.ca — 2025 Film and Television Production Statistics	2026-03-30
National sound-recording studio revenue	statcan.gc.ca — table 21-10-0055-01, ref. 2023	2025-01-24
Canadian recorded music and sync revenue 2025	musiccanada.com — IFPI Global Music Report 2026	2026-03-18
Toronto music sector counts — studios, labels, publishers, creators	toronto.ca — Toronto Music Industry Strategy 2022–2026	2022
Ontario studio business counts — NAICS 5122	ised-isde.canada.ca/app/ixb/cis/businesses-entreprises/5122	2025

ASHRAE noise criteria for recording studios	ASHRAE Handbook Ch. 48 Table 1 (via acousplan.com)	2026-03-20

LIMITATIONS

No owner-credentialled data was available for any party. Inaccessible: the operator's identity, entity, credits, client list and equipment schedule; the lease and the landlord's position on B3; the unit's dimensions, slab detail and mechanical noise floor; the neighbour's current commercial intentions; live social metrics on any platform; and domain registrar records for the six proposed domains.

Two specific evidentiary cautions carry into any onward use. First, the adjacent tenant's "largest in Canada" positioning is their own marketing copy, not a third-party finding — the most credible outlet to touch it framed it as a stated goal. Second, the celebrity client roster attributed to them is single-sourced to one local publication relaying the founders, with no dates and no corroboration; only one name carries first-party photographic evidence. None of it is used in this document or in the accompanying pitch page, and none of it should be.

Accordingly: this audit can say what is **unestablished** and what the published record **does and does not support**. It cannot say what any of it has cost or will earn. Quantifying that requires the access described above, beginning with A-01.

DGTL

Prepared by DGTL Group · dgtlgroup.io
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